



SCOTLAND'S FUTURE UNLEASHED

The Sovereignty Manifesto for the
2026 Scottish Parliament Elections

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**Jim Fairlie, Snr.,
Honorary
President,
Sovereignty**

Sovereignty is the supreme, absolute, and independent authority of a State to govern itself, make laws and control its territory without outside interference. It encompasses both internal supremacy (i.e. controlling domestic affairs) and external independence (i.e. acting autonomously in international relations).

The two components of sovereignty are internal sovereignty, i.e. the highest authority within a State's borders, such as parliamentary sovereignty in a UK context, and external sovereignty, which includes a State's autonomy and freedom from foreign control, often including recognition by other nations.

We are talking here about Scottish sovereignty and the ability of the Scottish people to govern themselves.

We must therefore remember that when we are talking about the sovereignty of the Scottish people and the recognition by other countries that Scotland has an inalienable right to govern itself and be recognized by other nations as completely independent.

EXERCISING SCOTTISH SOVEREIGNTY



Scottish independence is the first and central goal of Sovereignty. It is non-negotiable. It is the dream we will never relinquish, the future we know one day awaits.

We stand for a sovereign Scotland, for real independence from both the United Kingdom and European Union. Sovereignty resolve that it is not in the gift of any political party, prior to a definitive vote for full Independence, to decide, or promote what organisations the free people of Scotland might later join.

The SNP and Greens appear to be unwilling to make any moves towards independence, indeed, in the words of Sovereignty Leader, Brian Nugent, “they seem to be working against it”.

Sovereignty will not make the same mistake.

Support for Scottish Independence continues to grow. Scots are waking up to the grim realities of being a stateless nation. We see the UK failing, and we are waking up to the reality that for us, as a people, independence is an existential matter.

So, we would like to take you on a journey. A journey from the grim realities of a failing UK to a vision for a future Scotland that puts the Scottish people first.

This manifesto is the product of a Manifesto Workshop held in Dundee in October 2025. As a democratic party, the event was open to all paid-up members.

THE UK: A FAILING STATE

The UK is a failing state. The sense of malaise, of foreboding, of things going badly wrong with the UK, is held almost universally. According to a recent poll, only 5% of respondents felt that 2025 had been a fairly good year for the UK, and only 1%, a very good year.

The UK elite is actively supporting record numbers of legal and illegal migrants to enter the country. It has taken the side of the perpetrators of the rape gang scandal, not of the victims.

Its economy is a mess, highly financialised, and overdependent on the service sector. Industry accounts for less than 10% of UK output, down from 25–30% in the 1970s. In the 1950s, around half of Glasgow's jobs were in industry, today that's less than 15%, with 100,000 jobs being lost. Lower life expectancy and higher levels of deprivation have followed in its wake.

The UK legalised abortion up to birth. Today, a baby's chance of survival in the womb in the UK is lower than that of a soldier on the frontline in Ukraine.

Health and social care are in crisis. We are graduating too few doctors. Rural practices are being shuttered or run down. Patients are waiting too long for critical treatment. Our education systems are little better, with standards falling and Scotland's standing in international large-scale assessments of education having entered a secular decline.

The cost-of-living crisis continues to strain family finances. The jobs market is illiquid, and many employers are struggling with the taxation burdens placed on them by the state. Too many of our people are finding that full-time work does not pay enough to support a family, and must rely on benefits to pay their bills.

Without control of our natural resources, we are made to subsidise the UK with gas, oil, wind and tidal power, while the north of Scotland has the highest electricity bills in the UK.

Meanwhile, the UK acts as a divisive actor on the international stage, rather than pursuing "peace, prosperity and friendship with all nations".

SOVEREIGNTY & THE ALLIANCE TO LIBERATE SCOTLAND

Sovereignty is fielding candidates together with the Alliance to Liberate Scotland for the 2026 Scottish Parliament Election.

This is a tremendous initiative that aims to bring Scots from across the political spectrum together for the single aim of making independence happen.

The Alliance will have a 'one-line' manifesto: Independence, Nothing Less. If elected, our representatives will have a singular focus on getting independence over the line.

The SNP is 93 years old this year, and have done nothing about independence.

At the time of going to press the Alliance intends to field around 40 candidates, including candidates on every regional list. But more than this, we are committed to fielding constituency candidates as well, across the country.

At the constituency level, our candidates will stand for both Sovereignty and the Alliance. This means that they will be accountable for both driving independence forward, and advancing Sovereignty's distinctive vision for an independent Scotland.

CULTURE & EDUCATION

Despite the years of union, we have managed to preserve our sense of identity. As a people, we have traditionally put society and community first, not the state or individual. We have a strong sense of place, and of obligation to our neighbours. Many of us remember a time when people routinely left their front doors open. Where neighbours pulled together in a crisis. Where children were free to play on the streets without fear of being accosted.

Now, people are increasingly leading atomised lives, dominated by mass media and global information technologies. The value of work is being undermined by state policy and by a culture of dependency.

The Scottish education system, once the envy of the world, has been steadily regressing decade after decade. Realistically, it will be a 10–20 year process to reverse the influence of progressive education on the curricula, pedagogies and assessment systems used in our schools and colleges, but if elected, this is a fight that we will begin on day one in office. The 'Curriculum for Mediocrity' should be scrapped, and replaced with a true Curriculum for Excellence.

Programmes designed to indoctrinate students should be binned, and schools should be staffed by teachers with character, focused on the pursuit of truth, on rigorous academics, and students' welfare. We will end sex education in primary schools, and ban mobile phone use in schools.

Education should be more rounded. There should be common, merit-based exams at age 16, followed by preparation for university, or vocational education, apprenticeships in the context of the last two years of school. Schools should support a wider range of activities for students, including funded driving lessons. Further education should be put on the same level as higher education, with industry partnerships, and exacting vocational courses leading to well-paying careers.

Priority in our universities and colleges should be given to young Scots, not overseas students. We should better support parents and homeschooling families, by ensuring that those raising and educating their children at home are not pressured by the benefits system into finding work, and support marriage by ensuring that the basic allowance is fully transferable between parties in a married couple.

COMMUNITY & HOUSING

Scots are a communitarian people.

Community breakdown is the cause of major social problems. Local councils lack a strong connection with local communities. In communitarian Scotland, government should allow communities to take care of themselves. Undercover policing should stop undermining communities, neighbourhoods and families, diminishing the trust central for civil society.

The Gender Recognition Reform (GRR) should be repealed. No woman should feel unsafe using women's safe spaces. Women's safety should be prioritised as a matter of urgency.

Our prisons should be humane, focused on rehabilitation. Everyone has a right to a second chance. Instead, the less prisoners have to do, the more violent they become. There should be no indeterminate sentences, and no orders of lifelong imprisonment, decided on in shady, unaccountable proceedings. We will review the use of Orders for Lifelong Restriction (OLR), and replace them with a more just sentencing regime.

Scotland has one of the highest incarceration rates in Europe. Many of our communities have been blighted by ineffective government on drugs and drug crime, and undermining our national self-confidence. With independence, this will change!

One in three men, and one in ten women have a criminal record, making restoration into the jobs market challenging for many. We commit to fair trials, speedier justice, better systems of rehabilitation for prisoners, and an end to the dual role of the Lord Advocate.

The Scottish Parliament's hate crime legislation, named person laws, and bans on reasonable chastisement should be overturned or removed from the statute book.

With independence, migration law should continue to support families in staying together, while ensuring that citizenship remains primarily for those whose first identity is Scottish.

Crime and anti-social behaviour are tearing at the fabric of our towns and cities. We'll boost community policing, invest in youth prevention programmes, and crack down on the root causes like poverty and addiction. No more soft touches—real justice that protects the innocent and rehabilitates the guilty. This is how we rebuild community, communities where trust and cohesion are key, where there is mutual accountability and responsibility, and where we look out for the vulnerable.

State-sponsored propaganda for transgenderism and funding for charities that push the transgender agenda must end. Those with gender dysphoria should be supported, not affirmed.

Finally, we will support distinctively Scottish community organisations and cultural institutions. We will defend the status of our national sports teams, and will provide funding for both cultural and mass participation sporting events and activities.

Affordable housing should be available to all, without taking on crippling loans or mortgages. The crisis fueled by migration pressures and UK neglect has left too many Scots priced out or in substandard homes.

With independence, we'll launch a national building programme, incentivising affordable homes through grants and land reforms, but will do so in a manner that respects the traditions of Scotland's vernacular architecture. We'll consider using Annual Ground Rent revenues to fund social housing that keeps communities intact.

We'll invest £5 billion over 5 years to build 50,000 affordable homes, ensuring secure roofs for every family.

No more shortages—Scotland's land is for Scots.

ECONOMY & FINANCE

While we want to see the resource extraction and service sectors thrive, industry and manufacturing should once again lie at the heart of economic policy. We have outsourced food production, energy, and industrial capacity, and exported jobs elsewhere. Covid and the Iran War shows that we need to be as close to self-reliance as possible.

In an independent Scotland, all forms of energy generation will be supported, including both renewables and hydrocarbons. Not only will our industrial sector will be a beneficiary of our abundant sources of affordable energy, but we will also ensure that Scottish households benefit from the export of Scottish power and natural resources, in particular through the establishment of a national sovereign wealth fund. We'll seed our sovereign wealth fund with £10 billion in its first three years from oil and gas revenues.

We will open up our coastal waters to new oil and gas exploration projects, protect fields like Cambo, Jackdaw and Rosebank. We will support the revival of oil-refining capacity at Grangemouth, building on recent government investments to secure jobs and strategic importance, ensuring Scotland controls its energy future.

The regulatory and funding barriers to the re-emergence of heavy industry, steelmaking and shipbuilding in a Scottish context will be investigated, and where appropriate, removed.

Following independence, we will review external sanctions on foreign countries to ensure they are not harming civilian populations, and will encourage efforts globally towards trade war deescalation and conflict resolution.

We oppose LEZs as a tax on the poor, and will support our high streets by permitting greater vehicle access to pedestrianised zones, where appropriate, reducing local council dependency on parking charges.

We oppose freeports and regional taxation, as measures that erode the sovereignty and undermine the unity of Scotland as a country.

In a Holyrood context, we will ensure by simplifying Scotland's income tax into two bands - 19% and 38% - that no Scottish taxpayer pays more than their English counterpart. We will cut the tax burden on employers by 10% in year 1 to boost job creation and ease the labour market squeeze, creating 20,000 jobs.

We will encourage entrepreneurship, but encourage entrepreneurs to grow businesses for the benefit of the Scottish people, with a social purpose in mind. With independence, we will be able to stop our retail and care sectors being used as a front for bypassing immigration controls.

We will consider introducing an Annual Ground Rent (AGR), also known as a Land Value Tax, to ensure that large landowners pay their fair share. We will actively investigate replacing council tax and business rates with the AGR, ensuring more affordable homes and a fairer taxation system overall.

Furthermore, by reviewing Land and Buildings Transaction Tax (LBTT) rates, we will work to increase transactions in land back to a level more indicative of land being put to productive use. This will benefit users of land, not holders of it.

In the context of independence, we would seek to pursue trade deals with partners around the globe, moving beyond our traditional focus on trade with the EU.

We should tax non-domiciled corporations on their locally-derived revenues, and domiciled corporations on their profits. We will introduce mansion and private jet taxes to ensure the wealthy contribute fairly.

One income should be enough to support a family, and a husband and wife should be able to share a tax-free allowance between them—allowing joint filing with doubled thresholds. Families' wealth should not just be tied up in their homes, but should be more balanced across savings and investments.

On day one of independence, we will establish a Scottish Central Bank and issue our own currency, securing economic sovereignty.

SOCIAL PROTECTIONS

At Sovereignty, we are all equal in value. We commit to the protection of human life from conception until death. We oppose assisted suicide and euthanasia, which must remain illegal.

Instead, we will invest heavily in palliative care to ensure dignity for the vulnerable and terminally ill. We will reduce the abortion term limit and adopt a ‘Love them both’ attitude, protecting mothers and children post-birth with comprehensive support.

We oppose mandatory Digital ID, which undermines individual rights and acts as state-sponsored spyware on our people.

The right of self-defence should be protected in law. It should be permissible to carry pepper-spray in public.

Customers should have the right to pay in cash, preserving freedom and privacy in everyday transactions.

We will do everything with our power to better protect free speech from prescriptive legislation.

Poverty and inequality scar our nation, with child poverty a national shame. We will explore the introduction of a Negative Income Tax (NIT) to replace broken benefits, providing direct cash that rewards work and lifts families out of traps. However, a transformative NIT — replacing broken UK-wide benefits with direct, work-rewarding cash payments — can only be fully implemented with independence. Only independence will give Scotland the levers to introduce a simple, fair NIT that truly ends poverty traps for every family.

HEALTH, SOCIAL CARE & WELFARE

The NHS is a treasured institution, but under current conditions, it's crumbling. Waiting lists stretch for miles, doctors are fleeing, and our vulnerable are left in despair.

Independence is the only way to take full control and rebuild a healthcare system that puts patients first.

We will invest in training more doctors and nurses in order to address staff shortages, and will invest the estate and infrastructure of small practices within the NHS.

Social care for our elderly and disabled must be integrated with the NHS, not treated as an afterthought. We'll boost carer allowances, expand home care services. Palliative care will be a priority, with heavy investment to support the terminally ill without the shadow of state-sanctioned death.

We will move quickly to remove the benefit cliffs that disincentivise workers from doing more hours or taking on more responsibility at work. No one on in-work benefits should be penalised for earning more.

Most core benefits (Universal Credit, tax credits, Jobseeker's Allowance, much disability support) and the full income tax machinery (allowances, savings/dividends, HMRC administration) remain reserved to Westminster. Devolution allows top-ups and new Scottish benefits (like Scottish Child Payment), but not a complete redesign of the entire tax-benefit system.

In an independent Scotland, the disjointed relationship between UK and Scottish benefits would be over, allowing applicants to deal with a single point of contact for all benefits-related queries.

LAND REFORM & THE COMMONS

Too much of Scotland's land is owned by too few parties. The damage done by the Highland and Lowland Clearances has still to be addressed. We will end the financial incentives that reward the ownership of vast estates, and assist Scottish families to establish themselves in rural Scotland.

While the Scottish Government speaks a lot about the environment, little thought is given to the commons, and what it means for us as a people.

Scotland's landscapes, once renowned for their beauty, have increasingly been plastered with wind farms, which themselves have disrupted vital ecosystems. We will disincentivise the production and consumption of forever chemicals and harmful plastics.

While Bovaer profiteers raise a fuss over farting cows, billionaires fly around the globe in private jets lecturing us on environmentalism.

It is universally acknowledged that firms which pollute should be made to pay compensation for environmental harm.

Polluters should be made to pay. Taxes on polluters—known as Pigovian taxes—to compensate for environmental harm. Those charged with regulating industry should have a proper understanding of what constitutes responsible and irresponsible environmental impact.

Our fisheries should exist for the benefit of the Scottish fishing industry. Since 2021, Sovereignty has supported the principle of Scottish waters for Scottish boats, allowing only for genuinely reciprocal treaties with other neighbouring states. We stand with coastal communities in their opposition to Highly Protected Marine Areas (HPMA).

We will revoke the forthcoming ban on internal combustion engines (ICE), end carbon credits that enrich the elite, and oppose Low Emission Zones (LEZs) and Ultra Low Emission Zones (ULEZs) as a tax on the poor, destroying livelihoods and displacing pollution without real benefit.

THE ROAD TO INDEPENDENCE

So, how might our independence be regained?

First of all, not by doing nothing. Not by playing constantly into Westminster's hands. And not by making promises that we cannot keep.

Sovereignty advocates for a strategy of incrementally increasing the pressure and consequences on Westminster for its failure to provide a judicial or parliamentary route for Scotland to self-determine. This includes campaigning for the legitimacy of a Unilateral Declaration of Independence (UDI).

Should Westminster oppose efforts by the Scottish people to exercise our right of self-determination, even unilaterally — a right that it has supported in the case of other states like Kosovo — then it is only fair for the Scottish people and Scottish institutions to act to protect these inalienable rights.

We will disengage with bilateral institutions based on the 'regions and nations' of the UK, build international support for the exercise of Scottish sovereignty, and establish many of the institutions needed for an independent Scotland.



Having won a democratic mandate for independence, as soon as the ground has been laid, we will declare the 1707 Acts of Union to be null and void, and announce that Scotland has regained her independence.

If this approach has the support of the Scottish people, but is met with resistance by the British state, then the Scottish people will be within their rights peacefully to take to the streets. This is not a route that we want to take, but we are conscious that our birthright will not be returned to us on a plate.

Critical to this strategy is disengagement with the institutions of the British state. It's an approach that each of us can adopt now. It's one that creates consequences for the British state to which it must respond.

While the Independence Movement does not need to be united around questions of its vision for an independent Scotland or around political ideology, it is essential that we share a common strategic approach. The Alliance is one of the most promising initiatives in this direction, and our decision to align with it is taken for the sole purpose of uniting our efforts with fellow patriots seeking that Scotland once again be free.

6

Assert the Supremacy of the Scottish Parliament

7

Repeal the Act of Union and advance Independence Legislation

8

Declare Independence, if Necessary Unilaterally

9

Assume Control of Our Borders, Territory and Assets

10

Establish Diplomatic Relations with Foreign States

GET INVOLVED!

Please ensure that you are registered to vote by the deadline of Monday, 20 April 2026.

Sovereignty will be standing the following candidates in the national elections on Thursday, 7 May 2026:

- Flora Badger (Highlands & Islands)
- Andrew MacDonald (Caithness, Sutherland & Ross / Highlands & Islands)
- Kenneth Mackenzie (Na h-Eileanan an Iar / Highlands & Islands)
- Alan McManus (Cumbernauld & Kilsyth / Central Scotland & Lothians West)
- Laurie Moffat (Cowdenbeath / Mid Scotland & Fife)
- Brian Nugent (Shetland Islands / Highlands & Islands)

If you would like to campaign or canvass on behalf of our candidates, please be in touch via the contact details below.

You can apply to join Sovereignty via the party website: www.sovereignty.scot/join/. If you are a member of another party or otherwise ineligible, you can apply for Associate Membership of the party.

Sovereignty contests local, national and UK elections, as well as by-elections as they arise. If you are interested in standing as a candidate, or serving as an election agent, please let us know.

Our party is sustained financially by donations and membership payments. Donations may be made via our website, by standing order, or by cash or cheque at party events.

Our governing body is the National Executive Committee, which is currently at full complement. If you are interested in nominating a fellow party member to serve on the NEC, please do so in advance of our annual congress.

Contact Us

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behalf of Sovereignty, both of
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